

SUNBURST

The Newsletter for Seniors United Now

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The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

Another Advocacy Success!

In Late 2022 a SUN member wrote to SUN, they were shocked at what they had been forced to pay their medical practitioner for the required medical exam to renew their driver's license **\$200**. That communication set SUN on an advocacy path that started with a survey of senior's that was introduced in SUNBURST 58 April 2023 and online via our website. With over 200 responses, 55% of respondents stated they paid between **\$75 and \$150 for their exam and 9% paid more than \$150.**

SUN shared this information in May 2023 with:

Danielle Smith, Premier of Alberta - Rachel Notley, Leader of the Official

Opposition - Jason Copping, Minister of Health & Jeremy Nixon, Minister of Seniors, Community and Social Services. No response was received, therefore SUN sent additional communications in June 2023.

Finally, a response was received July 26, 2023, from Adriana LaGrange - Minister of Health stating "that Alberta Health is exploring options to reduce fees for seniors' driver medical exams based on their ability to pay". SUN responded in October 2023, stating "seniors are requesting that this fee be eliminated altogether".

January 30th, 2024, SUN President - Wayne Sorenson & Executive Director Linda Osborne met with Dana Mackie – Assistant Deputy Minister - Seniors, Community and Social Services & Jasvinder Chana - Executive Director, Seniors Strategic Planning. Several topics were discussed including these fees.

Finally, it was announced that effective April 1, 2024, Alberta seniors aged 65 and older are eligible to receive a 25% discount for medical exams and on personal registry services.

***While this was less than SUN was hoping for,
it is at least a step in the right direction.***

Please renew your membership, support our fundraising, donate and consider sharing our information with other seniors in your community.

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Presidents Report

SUN's many accomplishments and dealing with advocacy issues sure made this year go by very quickly, following is a brief review.

Our chapters have been very active, particularly the Sherwood Park/Strathcona County chapter. They have been very busy interacting with Strathcona County council, community groups and residents, advocating for the development of a new and much improved Senior Centre, similar to the ones located in Edmonton and other communities.

One of our major initiatives undertaken is our phone committees work on contacting our SUN members and encouraging them to renew their memberships. The previous issue of Sunburst, page 14 outlines what our members can do to increase our membership, which is essential for SUN to continue as a nonprofit organization.

Recently correspondence has been sent to Todd Mann, CEO of the Local Authority Pension Plan to keep us informed if they are able to continue to provide 100% of the cost-of-Living adjustment for the year 2025 and beyond.

Also, as a result of SUN meeting with the Seniors Minister's office, all seniors over age 65 have enjoyed a 25% discount when they renew their driver's operator's license and their vehicle registration. For seniors that had to pay out of pocket for a medical practitioner's cognitive test, if they provide the receipt to the licensing agency, they will submit that information to Alberta Health and a 25% refund will be issued to the senior within 10 days.

On November 6, I attended a town hall meeting in Edmonton, where discussion took place on the importance of staying in the Canada Pension Plan rather than switching into the Alberta Government proposed Alberta Pension Plan. Interesting to note that on that same day, the Government announced that they were dismissing the current Alberta Investment Management Corporation board of directors and the C.E.O. They stated, "their concerns are over poor investment performance and huge increases to administration costs". Their mandate is to make investments on behalf of several pension plans and the Alberta Heritage Trust Fund. Just recently our past Prime Minister, Stephen Harper has been announced as the new CEO and new board members are currently in the process of being selected. It is interesting to note that recent media comments are that politics may play a role in future investment strategies, but only time will tell.

Our SUN Board of Directors, Administration staff and our chapter members have been working hard to keep everyone informed of important issues that affect Alberta Seniors.

SUN Board and Staff are beginning to put the building blocks in place for our upcoming April 16, 2025 Annual General Meeting.

Our Chapters are functioning well and are busy putting in place guest speakers for the new year. SUN has accomplished another successful year.

Wishing all of you a happy December holiday season and good health and prosperity in the New Year.

Sincerely,
Wayne Sorenson, President



Executive Director Report

I hope you enjoyed our great fall and now winter has set in, it's time to stay warm and safe.

Thank you to all the chapter leaders for arranging some wonderful presentations by guest speakers for our chapter members. As we have in the past few years, we will be organizing a virtual meeting for all our members to attend. On February 10, 2025, our virtual guest speaker will be Chris Galloway, Executive Director at Friends of Medicare. Chris will be talking about what Friends of Medicare is all about and how they help advocate for the citizens of Alberta. So, I hope that you will mark that date on your calendar for this informational presentation.

I continue to attend meetings with other organizations to keep up to date with what they are doing, and to keep our Board and membership informed, so we at SUN can continue to advocate for seniors. Public Interest Alberta and Friends of Medicare have several campaigns that are focused on seniors. These are:

- "Seniors Deserve Better" which focuses on continuing care, for profit vs publicly operated facilities, subsidized fees for residential with rising costs, dismantling of Alberta Health Services and how the new system is going to benefit seniors.
- "Save our CPP" presentations and townhalls are being held throughout the provinces in opposition of the proposed Alberta pension.
- The return of the Independent Senior Advocate
- Pharmacare – how this will benefit Seniors

You, too, can help. Visit the Friends of Medicare and Public Interest Alberta websites and use their letter writing campaign to let our government know how you feel and the changes you would like to see.

In the New Year, I will continue to attend the various meetings of other organizations and advocate for senior issues.

Happy Holidays to all of you

Respectfully submitted, Linda Osborne sunexdir@telus.net 780-920-3058



As the creator of the Retire Abundantly Process, Scott and his team help retiree's upgrade their retirement and leave a lasting legacy.

For your FREE retirement resources kit, or to schedule a complimentary 57 minute Retire Abundantly Assessment please contact:

info@sjbwealthmangement.com

780-237-9630



www.sjbwealthmangement.com

South Edmonton Chapter**A message to our chapter members**

Meetings of South Edmonton Chapter are held at the Whitemud Public Library (4211-106 St.) in the Program Room. Registration is now at 2:15pm and the presentation is at 2:30 pm. We wish to thank the library and its staff for the support we received during the past year. Also, we thank McDonalds 23rd Ave & 110th St for the complimentary coffee and snacks provided for each meeting.

Everyone is welcomed at our meetings, member or non-member.
If you are interested in joining SUN or our chapter executive, please contact us.
Chapter executive assist at our events and attend our chapter planning meetings, which are usually held monthly. Contact information is below.

**WHAT HAPPENED...**

September 20, 2024 Nancy Wang, from the Seniors Outreach Program spoke on how seniors can contact various organizations in Edmonton to receive information about relevant services and programs. There are ten organizations that can refer older adults to services such as financial assistance, help with forms, home care, housing, social groups, housekeeping, snow removal, yardwork, moving help and health issues. Seniors can call 211 and press 2 for the Seniors Information phone line, walk into any of the ten agencies or visit: [Seniors Home Supports Program - Home](#) This was an excellent presentation with valuable handouts containing vital information.

October 18, 2024 Nicole Davis, Housing Placement Coordinator from Greater Edmonton Foundation (GEF) Housing, spoke about the Home Support Program, what the service looks like, how to access it, eligibility, types of accommodation, and locations. It was a thorough presentation, there were plenty of good handouts.

November 15, 2024 Shawna and Bryon Steinwand, owners of Pro Tours, spoke on the topic "Let's talk About Travel", while Pam Lavold, Pharmacist/Owner, spoke about "Are your Routine and Vaccines Up to Date?" She gave a long list of Vaccines that could be required depending on what part of the world a person was travelling. A SUN umbrella was given as a door prize.

WHAT'S UPCOMING...

January 17, 2025 Cindy Gordon, Program Director of Canadian Hard of Hearing Assoc. Edmonton Branch, will speak on the topic "Seniors and Hearing Problems".

February 21, 2025 & March 21, 2025 Topic & Guest Speaker To Be Confirmed

Reminder: registration, as noted above, will start at 2:15 pm and the presentations will begin at 2:30 pm.

Chair: Robert Price 780-250-7164 price4583@gmail.com

**Annual General Meeting April 16, 2025**

Seniors United Now Society - AGM will be held on Wednesday April 16, 2025

Santa Maria Goretti Centre 11050-90 Street NW Edmonton, Alberta

Doors open for Attendance 9:30 am Meeting Commences 10:00 am

Special Presentation 11:00 am – Luncheon @ noon

Pre-Registration and payment is required and will be available in February 2025
(Luncheon is included with Registration Fee)



The Importance of Advance Planning

Life can be unpredictable, but planning ahead can offer comfort, especially when it comes to aging or supporting aging family members. At Peace of Mind Concierge, we often work with families who are navigating difficult decisions in the face of unexpected situations. One of the most powerful tools to avoid stress during these times is advance planning.

Why Do Caregivers Need to Plan Ahead? Advance planning is about being proactive rather than reactive. It allows individuals and families to clearly **outline wishes, financial decisions, and care preferences** before health declines or emergencies occur. This not only ensures that their desires are respected, but also alleviates a lot of the stress from family members who might otherwise have to make difficult decisions under pressure.

Without a plan in place, family members are often left scrambling to figure out healthcare preferences, financial arrangements, or long-term care options. These decisions can cause strain and confusion, sometimes leading to family conflict or undesired outcomes for your family member. By planning ahead, you're **giving your family the gift of clarity, control, and comfort** in knowing that all the bases are covered.

Advance Planning is in Everyone's Best Interests. Advance planning allows seniors to have a say in their future care. Many aging parents have specific preferences when it comes to the type of care they receive, how their finances are managed, or where they will live when they cannot care for themselves anymore. Making and communicating those decisions early on ensures their voice is heard, even if they become unable to express themselves later. This is particularly important in cases of Alzheimer or serious illness, where **decision-making abilities can quickly become compromised**.

Advance planning also helps families avoid the **emotional and financial toll** of making rushed decisions. The cost of long-term care, medical treatments, or assisted living can be significant, and without proper planning, families may find themselves facing financial strain. Having a plan in place helps outline how these costs will be covered, whether through savings, government funded benefits, insurance, or other means. This gives everyone involved peace of mind, knowing they are prepared for the financial responsibilities that may be to come.

Advance Planning Should be Done Together. Advance planning strengthens family unity. When everyone is on the same page, with a clear understanding of what their family member wants, it **minimizes misunderstandings and disagreements among family members**. Siblings, for example, may have differing opinions on what's best for their parent, and without a plan, these conflicts can escalate. By planning ahead, families can avoid these challenges, ensuring decisions are made with compassion and cooperation. Advance planning is not just about making decisions in advance—it's about empowering family members, protecting family dynamics, and ensuring a smoother, less stressful journey through the caregiving process.

The Family Compass Advance Planning Guide. To make this process easier, we've created the Family Compass Planning Guide. This comprehensive tool helps families navigate the complexities of eldercare and future planning. It walks you through important considerations, such as legal documentation, financial information, and even end-of-life preferences. The guide is designed to be user-friendly and encourages thoughtful conversations between family members, **ensuring everyone is on the same page when it comes to caregiving responsibilities and future care needs**. With the Family Compass Planning Guide, you'll have a roadmap to guide important decisions, reduce stress, and feel confident that your loved one's wishes are honoured. Get your copy online here. <https://www.peacemindconcierge.com/product-page/the-family-compass>

At Peace of Mind Concierge, we're here to **support you every step of the way**. Whether you need help navigating local resources or creating a customized plan for your family, our goal is to ensure you feel empowered and informed.

Reach out to us today to get started with the Family Compass Planning Guide and take the first step toward a future where you and your loved ones can have peace of mind

<https://www.peacemindconcierge.com/resources>



A Resource Guide to
Assist with Decision
Making

**United Nations Principles for Older Persons
ADOPTED 16 December 1991 BY
General Assembly resolution 46/91 Share**

Independence

1. Older persons should have access to adequate food, water, shelter, clothing and health care through the provision of income, family and community support and self-help.
2. Older persons should have the opportunity to work or to have access to other income-generating opportunities.
3. Older persons should be able to participate in determining when and at what pace withdrawal from the labour force takes place.
4. Older persons should have access to appropriate educational and training programs.
5. Older persons should be able to live in environments that are safe and adaptable to personal preferences and changing capacities.
6. Older persons should be able to reside at home for as long as possible.

Participation

7. Older persons should remain integrated in society, participate actively in the formulation and implementation of policies that directly affect their well-being and share their knowledge and skills with younger generations.
8. Older persons should be able to seek and develop opportunities for service to the community and to serve as volunteers in positions appropriate to their interests and capabilities.
9. Older persons should be able to form movements or associations of older persons.

Care

10. Older persons should benefit from family and community care and protection in accordance with each society's system of cultural values.
11. Older persons should have access to health care to help them to maintain or regain the optimum level of physical, mental and emotional well-being and to prevent or delay the onset of illness.
12. Older persons should have access to social and legal services to enhance their autonomy, protection and care.
13. Older persons should be able to utilize appropriate levels of institutional care providing protection, rehabilitation and social and mental stimulation in a humane and secure environment.
14. Older persons should be able to enjoy human rights and fundamental freedoms when residing in any shelter, care or treatment facility, including full respect for their dignity, beliefs, needs and privacy and for the right to make decisions about their care and the quality of their lives.

Self-fulfilment

15. Older persons should be able to pursue opportunities for the full development of their potential.
16. Older persons should have access to the educational, cultural, spiritual and recreational resources of society.

Dignity

17. Older persons should be able to live in dignity and security and be free of exploitation and physical or mental abuse.
18. Older persons should be treated fairly, regardless of age, gender, racial or ethnic background, disability or other status, and be valued independently of their economic contribution

SUN Board of Directors 2024 – 2025

Wayne Sorenson - President Stan Poznanski - Vice-President William Holtz - Treasurer
Gloria Krenbrenk – Secretary Robert Price - Director Gerald Northam - Director
Frances Burkitt - Director Rita DeLongchamp-Osborne - Director

SUN Staff

Linda Osborne - Executive Director Lynn Penner - Office Admin Deborah Wilson - Membership Coordinator

North Edmonton Chapter**Quarterly Activity Summary**

We continue to hold our meetings at Glengarry Community Hall, 13325 – 89 street, Edmonton. Registration begins at 1:00 p.m. and the meeting commences at 1:30 p.m. Our volunteers continue to step forward to arrange the seating requirements as well as the post meeting clean up requirements. If you have some computer skills, please step forward as we need a recording secretary. If you can help, contact Wayne Sorenson at 780-964-1142.

At each meeting, we host excellent guest speakers who discuss a variety of seniors topics. At the end of each meeting, we have a Save on Foods gift card door prize and a 50/50 draw. Everyone is welcome, bring a friend and enjoy the fellowship, free baked goods and tea and coffee. A very special thank you to Save on Foods located at 167 Ave. and 50th street for their donation of tasty treats for our meetings.

**WHATS HAPPENED?****October 10, 2024**

Justin Kumar and Karalynn Tran conducted a presentation on Identity Theft and Fraud Prevention and contributing to the enhancement of financial literacy within our community. Workbooks were provided.

November 14, 2024

Guest speakers Devon Belcourt and Justin Kumar informed us on how to improve financial security through saving and asset-building, reduce anxiety and stress around family finances, increasing access and awareness to safe, affordable financial products and services. Workbooks were provided.

WHATS UPCOMING?**January 9, 2025**

Guest speaker, Denise Roy-Popal, community support manager of the Greater Edmonton Foundation, Senior Housing. Denise will describe what the foundation does, the types of Seniors Accommodation offered, contact information, the locations offered, eligibility, the application process and wait time, rates and fees.

February 13, 2025

Guest speaker Nancy Wang, from the Seniors Council, will inform us on 10 organizations that can refer seniors to services such as financial assistance, help with completing forms, home care, housing, social groups, housekeeping, snow removal, yard work, moving help and health issues.

March 13, 2025**Topic to be announced**

Wayne Sorenson – Chair, North Edmonton Chapter

wm.s1@telus.net 780-964-1142

***Season's Greetings***

*Christmas brings family and friends together; it helps us appreciate the love in our lives we can often take for granted.
May the true meaning of the holiday season fill your heart and home with many blessings.*

Seniors United Now Board of Directors & Staff

Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)**Quarterly Activity Summary**

Chapter meetings are held on the 3rd Tuesday of each month except April, July, August, and December. Registration at 1:00p.m. Meetings commence at 1:30pm and are held at Bethel Lutheran Church located at 298 Bethel Drive, Sherwood Park, which is fully accessible. Members and non-members are welcome. Our presenters answer many questions during and after their presentations and are thanked with an appreciation gift. ***A special thank you to the Sherwood Park Real Canadian Superstore for supplying us for cookies***

**What's Happened?****October 15, 2024 - Chapter meeting: Presentation: FCS (Family Community Services) Supports for Seniors**

Presenters: Ashley Swyck and Doneka Simmons, Registered Social Workers and Solutions Navigators with Strathcona County FCS. This was a very informative presentation with a great deal of insight into what was available for anyone needing assistance in many areas – and many questions were forthcoming. A Sharing took place as to what barriers seniors are facing in their personal lives. The FCS website page is especially dedicated to the problems seniors face. Their office is located on the second floor of the County Bldg. Also mentioned was the Persons in Care Act related to elder abuse and what rights they have to access help. Their services are free to all people earning \$33,410 or less. Also mentioned was Heartland Housing that can provide affordable housing to those in need in Strathcona County. The Greater Edmonton Foundation (GEF) also provides subsidized housing in the Edmonton Area. The SAGE – Directory is another resource that lists private operators and government agencies that provide housing for seniors. Also mentioned was the Alberta Seniors Benefit Plan that is offered to those who qualify.

November 19, 2024 Chapter Meeting Topic: Healing Grief and Surviving the Holiday Season.**Presenter: Valerie Umscheid, MA R. Psych. Licensed Psychologist and Author**

Valerie inspires you to make healthy choices in your life to promote optimum mental health. She shares her experience as a therapist and mentor to inspire you to have your best life. Relationship problems, body image issues, stress, grief, trauma, depression, anxiety, are common problems she addresses with real solutions. Valerie delivered an inspiring presentation, and people were asked and shared some of their experiences of grief in their lives and how had they handled it. Valerie offered suggestions on honoring loved ones at Christmas, on birthdays, or other special occasions. She offered copies of her book at cost and many people purchased them.

Supplementary Questions (not answered at our September meeting due to a lack of time) were also covered on paper by Kyle Kasawski, MLA for Sherwood Park regarding a new Seniors Centre in Sherwood Park, the existing hospital in Sherwood Park and whether it should specialize in geriatric treatment, the new dental plan and what can be done to make it better. To see his answers please refer to the November chapter minutes.

WHATS UPCOMING?**Jan. 21, 2025 – What kind of Supports and Services are needed for Seniors in Strathcona County?****Presenter: Haidong Liam, PhD MA, B.R.M.C.D Gerontologist and Executive Director of WESeniors Strathcona**

February 18, 2025 March 18, 2025 May 20, 2025
Topics and Speakers to be announced

See Page 9 for an update on our Advocacy for a Senior's Center

SUN continues to work for you.

Report respectfully submitted by: Denis Beaudry

Join us!

We welcome your wisdom, experience, and enthusiasm!



Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)

Continued from Page 8

What's Happening: Advocacy for Strathcona Seniors Centre (ASC)

September 26, 2024 – ASC Committee Meeting – Preparing for next steps – After our eight visits to seniors' centres in Aug. & Sept. (3 - Edmonton, 1 - St. Albert, 4 - Strathcona County), along with discussions with each of those Boards – we reviewed our data. After realizing that several Councillors had not actually visited other senior centres, we decided to show images of each of the eight centres along with the strengths and weaknesses of each, so we could get all Councillors on the same page. We especially needed to demonstrate that what we have within the County in our four seniors' centres, as compared to what a modern seniors' centre has. We wanted Councillors to see for themselves the shortcomings of what we offer within the County of Strathcona.

October 3, 2024 – Meeting with Councillors Anderson and Harvey – Four of us met with both Councillors seeking advice and information regarding how Councillors would react to our presentation. We specifically wanted to know what barriers and questions we would be facing when presenting our report at our upcoming Priorities Meeting. We informed them about all the research we had done over the summer plus the awesome data Marianne had put together for the presentation. Mostly, Councillors encouraged us to keep our presentation positive and upbeat.

October 8, 2024 – ASC presented at the Priorities Meeting.

Many thanks to Marianne West for the wonderful presentation. Marianne spent hours assembling our data, compiling all the important details that Councillors needed to know. Our information answered all the questions posed to us during our many sit-in meetings with individual councillors over the past months, which we brought to their attention. Council fully appreciated that we were collaborating with seniors' Centres within the County, which is what they wanted to hear.

November 21, 2024 Presentation to Strathcona County Council The purpose of the five-minute presentation was to bring Strathcona County Council up to date on the work that the Advocacy for a Seniors Centre (ASC) committee has been doing over the last few months. Barb Milne, one of our ASC members presented on behalf of the committee asking council to continue to honour our request for a comprehensive Senior Centre. The outstanding presentation also updated council on our efforts to work with the 55+ Club on achieving Charitable Status which they presently do not have. The meeting with the 55+ Club helped us to determine that we would be better served by starting a new society with fresh ideas, a new set of bylaws and a larger mandate that could serve a broader range of seniors in Strathcona County. Council members one after the other, including the mayor, were delighted with our presentation, voiced many positive comments and congratulated our team effort on the completeness of our work. We encourage all our members to look at the 5-minute presentation below and to view the reactions by council! Click on the link and you can skip over to 1:27 where our presentation starts.

<https://pub-strathcona.escribemeetings.com/Players/ISISStandAlonePlayer.aspx?id=6e265adb-a527-4e62-97a9-f87f1a903773>

November 23, 2024 ASC members attended a Governance and Healthy Organization Workshop which focused on the skills of working together as members of a Board.

December 11, 2024 Family and Social Services (FCS) will be giving a final presentation of the Older Adult Survey Results. FCS have engaged a renowned speaker, talking about AGEISM in our society. There will be an opportunity to visit a variety of displays pertaining to seniors after the presentation. Seniors United Now and the ASC Committee will both be manning tables at this event.

Advocacy for Strathcona Seniors Centre update
Respectfully submitted by Claudette McLean

Join us!

We welcome your wisdom, experience, and enthusiasm!



Legacy Planning

"I hate estate planning!" Warren complained. "It's hard to admit, but I'm worried. Shirley and I are trying to figure out if we'll have enough money for retirement, and now everyone's pushing me to think about what I'll leave behind when I die. Am I the only one stressing about this? We have more money than I ever imagined, and yet I still worry. It feels strange to be a millionaire and still be anxious about running out of money." He paused, catching his breath. His friend George jumped in. "There was a survey done with people who have between \$3 million and \$10 million in wealth. Guess how many said they were very concerned about losing their wealth?" "I'd guess more than half. Maybe even more," Warren answered. "Even more," George replied, shaking his head. "Nine out of ten said they were very worried about losing their wealth!" He leaned in. "I met a specialist who said the most important three-letter word in wealth planning is YOU. Everything begins with you—your lifestyle, your needs, your goals. Only after you address that, do you think about your heirs and charitable giving. He referred to wealth having two sides like a coin, the 'lifestyle/legacy coin.' Both sides need to be part of your wealth plan, because that will guide how you use your investments for income during retirement." Warren furrowed his brow. "So how do I know if my portfolio is protected during the drawdown phase?" George nodded. "The specialist told me something that really stuck: 'You've spent your life accumulating wealth, but now you must switch gears. You're not just building wealth anymore; you need to protect it as you start drawing from it.' He used an acronym called TRICK to evaluate my situation." George explained, "It stands for:

T: Taxes—are you paying unnecessary taxes? **R: Risk—**are you taking on more risk than you need to?
I: Investment Mix—Do you have the right mix? Or are you stop/starting? **C: Costs—**Am I aware of the cost?
Are there hidden costs? **K: Knowledge Gaps—**Are there knowledge gaps? **AND What are they?**

Warren was taking it all in. "That makes sense. But how do I know if I'm set up for the long haul?" George grinned. "The specialist said something else that resonated with me: 'You've worked too hard to not enjoy what you have now. Don't wait until you die to make your plan work.' I just read that life expectancy for the average Canadian compared to 100 years ago has gone up by 25 years. What will those extra years mean for your investments? You need to start asking that question today." Warren nodded, the pieces starting to fall into place. He looked George in the eye. "We've been lied to! All these retirement articles keep saying my lifestyle will drop by a third. But which third are they talking about? My fixed expenses aren't going anywhere. So, the only things I'd be cutting are travel and hobbies. But I've worked too hard my whole life just to sit around in retirement. I don't buy it—my lifestyle might actually go up if Shirley and I do even half of what we've been dreaming of." "Exactly!" George said. "So, what's the next step?" Warren paused. "What should I do now?" "Find a specialist and get an integrated economic model of your current plan," George advised. "You can't see the label when you are inside the bottle. You need a clear picture of how your lifestyle and wealth will evolve over time and compare that to your ideal vision for the future. If you're not happy with where your current plan is heading, make the changes you need with the right information. You and I both know there are no panaceas, there are always interactions between everything you introduce. You won't know the impact of how one change can impact another, and you need the right tools to make those decisions." Warren looked at George. "And you? Have you followed your own advice?" "Already done!" George replied with a knowing smile. **"I'm living my legacy, not just leaving one".**

Scott Bokenfohr is president and founder of SJB Wealth Management Inc., a legacy planning company in Edmonton.

Our next Cash Raffle is:



"It's a Chili Day"

February 27, 2025

License #715981

Join our growing list of SUN winners!
 See page 14 for ticket order form
 purchase online: www.seniorsunitednow.com

Tickets \$5.00 each 5 Tickets \$10.00 20 tickets \$20.00

Please consider supporting SUN's critical fundraising.



CASH RAFFLE – Winners

"Halloween Hoot"

October 31, 2024

License #700801

Congratulations to SUN members:

R.Garvey Edmonton, AB ticket #155

C. Otto Edmonton, AB Ticket #362

Thanks to all members for supporting SUN's critical fundraising by purchasing tickets!



Effective April 1, 2024, Alberta seniors aged 65 and older will be eligible to receive a 25% discount on personal registry services.

Overview: Services eligible for the seniors' discount include driver's licence renewals, passenger vehicle registrations, driver's abstracts, marriage licences and birth certificates.

The seniors' discount is a Government of Alberta initiative designed to make life more affordable for seniors.

Who is eligible: The seniors' discount is available to individuals aged 65 and over who reside in Alberta. To receive a discount on eligible services, you must be 65 or older on the date of purchase.

•The seniors' discount is available to seniors, and agents acting on behalf of a senior for motor vehicles and vital statistics services. The seniors' discount is available to seniors who are part of a group accessing a service (for example: joint vehicle registration). **How the discount will be processed:** The discount will be applied to eligible services at point of sale at any Alberta registry agent office. Seniors purchasing personal registry services online through MyAlberta eServices will also be able to access the discount, but not all services eligible for the discount are available online.

•For example: first-time driver's licence or ID card applications, first-time vehicle registration or vehicle transfers, address changes, or driver's licence reclassifications must be processed in person at a registry agent.

Reimbursement for Driver's Medical Examinations

Seniors can receive 25% back on the cost of a driver's medical examination at any Alberta registry in a few simple steps.

1. Complete the exam at your physician's office and get a receipt that includes your name, service provided, date and physician's details (clinic, address, phone number) and the amount paid for the service.

2. Bring the receipt to your local registry office.

3. Upon receiving the receipt, a registry agent will verify eligibility, calculate the 25% discount, and issue a credit.

4. The credit will be processed, and you will be reimbursed the 25% discount in the form of a government-issued cheque which will be mailed to the address on your motor vehicles file within 10 business days.

The discount applies to driver's medical examinations completed on or after April 1, 2024, if a valid physician issued receipt is provided.

Restrictions

•The seniors' discount does not apply to corporate and business services, personal property services, commercial vehicle registrations or optional products such as personalized and specialty licence plates.

•Seniors' discounts will not be applied to services that are tied to punitive measures, or to enforcing traffic safety (for example: fines, ignition interlock and restricted licence applications).

Next steps

Work is ongoing to develop a discount for camping fees.

More details will be available later in 2024

<https://www.alberta.ca/seniors-discount>



SUN Administrator Lynn Penner - Camping



Get exclusive group savings.

Plus, save even more when you bundle your home and car insurance.

Did you know that as an affinity group member, you get access to exclusive savings on enhanced car and home insurance coverage?



Access add-ons like:

- **Temporary replacement vehicle coverage** so you can stay in the driver's seat
- **Accident Forgiveness™** so your premium won't go up as a result of your first at-fault accident*



Get extra coverage at no additional cost:

- **Up to \$25,000 in protection** for identity theft and cyberattacks
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Get a quote at belairdirect.com/exclusive-savings or 833-887-3399

Certain conditions, eligibility requirements, limitations and exclusions apply to all offers. Visit belairdirect.com for more details. Offers may change without notice. We offer car insurance and home insurance in Alberta, Ontario, Quebec, New Brunswick, Nova Scotia, Newfoundland and Labrador and Prince Edward Island and home insurance only in British Columbia. *In Quebec, Accident Forgiveness prevents your insurance premium from going up as a result of your first two at-fault accidents. *NO PURCHASE NECESSARY. Open September 1st, 2024 to August 31, 2025 to legal residents of Canada (excluding MB, SK, NU, NT, YT,) who at the time of entry: (1) have reached the age of majority in their jurisdiction of residence and (2) are a member of an eligible recognized group with whom belairdirect has an insurance agreement. Odds of winning depend on the number of eligible entries received. Math skill test required. Rules: belairdirect.com/2500prizerules © 2023, Belair Insurance Company Inc. All rights reserved

Get your quote today with group ID code ASUNS

Visit belairdirect.com/healthcare or call 1-833-887-4626

SUN is offering every current SUN member the opportunity to gift a **FREE** 6-month membership to another senior. How do you do this? Complete the Membership gift form and send it to the SUN admin office and we will do all the rest.

belairdirect.



Win 1 of 12 cash prizes of \$2,500*

Simply scan the QR code and enter for your chance to win!

belairdirect.com/2500prize



SUN MEMBERSHIP GIFT valid – October – December 2024

Gift Memberships will be due for renewal June 2025

Current Member Name: _____ Membership# _____

Gift Membership details:

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ Email _____

Year of Birth: _____ If available (used for SUN demographics only will not be shared) For Office USE: _____

Message from your Membership Coordinator

Membership is the only way SUN has to fund the programs and materials we provide for our members. It is a very **important** aspect of running our advocacy program. If we are to continue to be the Voice of Seniors in Alberta, we need you to renew your memberships, invite your friends to our Chapter meetings, purchase our 50/50 tickets and of course volunteer and support our events.

Join us on up-to-date information on our Facebook page. You will find updates on upcoming Chapter events and more. If you have a Facebook page search Seniors United Now and join our page, invite your friends.

We will be planning more ZOOM presentation in 2025. Stay tuned to our webpage, Facebook, email updates and of course our SUNBURST newsletters.

If you have any ideas on how to increase our membership, I would be open to hearing from you. You can reach me by email at suncoord@telus.net Chapters need your support to keep running so consider volunteering at their meetings. Membership has its rewards with benefits of new friendships, information and support.

I look forward to working for you for a better SUN. Merry Christmas and the best in the New Year.

Deborah Wilson, Membership Coordinator



PEACE OF MIND
CONCIERGE

EXPERT SENIORS SUPPORT FOR YOU AND YOUR FAMILY

Tammy Lautner, RSW
Seniors Supports
Specialist/Caregiver Consultant

Explore Housing Options with Ease:
We will take the work out of finding suitable housing that fits your needs.

Master the Healthcare System:
Receive clear, expert guidance to navigate the complex healthcare landscape with confidence.

Compassionate Family Assistance:
Let's work together to find personalized solutions for caring for your senior family member.

Call or email Tammy Lautner:
780-720-3035
info@peacemindconcierge.com



Nov 11, 2024
Remembrance
Day service at the
Kingsway Legion

Thanks to the SUN Board Director
Rita DeLongchamp – Osborne
for attending and placing the SUN
wreath.



Please renew your membership, support our fundraising, donate and volunteer if you are able.

It's a Chili Day

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ For Office USE: _____

Email _____
(please print)

Individual Tickets: _____ Tickets \$5.00 each \$ _____ (40 available)

5 tickets \$10.00 _____ Sets \$10.00 each \$ _____ (60 sets available)

20 tickets \$20.00 _____ Sets \$20.00 each \$ _____ (110 sets available)

Draw Date: February 27, 2025**License #715981****Please make your cheque
payable to SUN****RAFFLE RULES**

- 1) Raffle tickets must not be sold to a person under the age of 18 years. Purchasers must be Alberta residents.
- 2) The purchase price of each ticket shall be: \$5.00 each OR 5 tickets \$10.00 OR 20 tickets \$20.00
- 3) To be eligible for draws, the ticket order and purchase amount must be received in SUN office by 10:00am, February 27, 2025
- 4) The prize payout shall be as follows:
1st prize 30% of the gross ticket sale revenue
2nd prize 20% of the gross ticket sale revenue
- 5) The draw(s) shall be made at the SUN office: #37 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, AB T8A3X3 prior to 3pm, February 27, 2025
- 6) The winning ticket buyers shall be notified by telephone; their names will be publicized in the next newsletter & on the SUN website. The winning ticket buyers will be awarded the prize via cheque drawn on SUN.
- 7) In the event of any concern or dispute regarding this raffle, please contact Lynn Penner at the SUN administration office. 780-449-1816
- 8) Raffle tickets are official when payment is received & numbers issued by the sun raffle chairman.
- 9) Your Ticket numbers are available by contacting the SUN office

**SUN MEMBERSHIP Renewal / Donation Nov – Dec 2024**Individual: ☐ \$25 per year ☐ \$50 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$200Joint: ☐ \$40 per year ☐ \$80 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$300**Donation in addition to membership dues**☐ \$5 ☐ \$10 ☐ \$15 ☐ \$20 ☐ \$25 ☐ other \$ _____

Renewal \$ _____ Donation \$ _____ Raffle \$ _____

Please make cheque payable to Seniors United Now

Signed Cheque(s) enclosed Chq# _____ Total \$ _____

Membership # _____ (see Back Page)

Joint Member (if applicable) Membership # _____

☐ YES - replace my membership card☐ YES - replace my membership card**(Please attach a stamped self-addressed stamped envelope if you are requesting a replacement card)**

Name: _____

Name: _____

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Address: _____

(If different from mailing label on reverse)

Renew your membership online! SUN uses the PayPal system, for secure online renewals & donations**Etransfer may also be used for membership payments and donations. unitenow@telus.net**

Phone: _____ Email: _____ (send me electronic SUN information)

(Please print clearly)

☐ YES – I am interested in volunteering, please contact me.

Thank-You for your prompt renewal. Renewals & donations may also be made by Etransfer to unitenow@telus.net or online via our website